

Mohammad Ala-Uddin, Ph.D.

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Global Communication and Social Change; Ethical and Responsible Use of AI; Digital Media, Politics, and Culture; Platform Governance and Networked Publics; ICT for Development (ICT4D); Computational-Critical Methods; Gender, Communication, and Development

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor of Communication Studies, Saint Mary's College, IN (2024–present)

Affiliate: Digital and Public Humanities | Global Studies | Gender and Women's Studies

Lecturer & Graduate Instructor, School of Comm. Studies, James Madison U (2019–2024)

Faculty Affiliate: African, African American, and Diaspora Studies; Adult Degree Program

Teaching Associate, School of Media & Communication, Bowling Green State U (2015–2019)

Research Assistant, International Studies & School of Media Arts and Studies, Scripps College of Communication, Ohio University, OH (2012–2014)

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Media and Communication, Bowling Green State University, OH, 2022

Dissertation: Reclaiming the "C" in ICT4D: A Critical Examination of Discursive (Un)Freedoms in Digital State Policy and News Media of Bangladesh and Norway

M.A., International Affairs, Ohio University, Athens, OH, 2014

Center for International Studies and Scripps College of Communication

M.A., Journalism, Media and Communication, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh, 2010

B.A., Islamic History and Culture, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh, 2008

Minors: Sociology, Political Science

AWARDS AND HONORS

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| 2026 | Top Paper Award , Philosophy of Communication, Theory, and Critique Division, National Communication Association (NCA), New Orleans, LA |
| 2025 | Best Reviewer Award , Environmental Communication Division, National Communication Association (NCA) Annual Convention, Denver, CO |
| 2022 | Top Dissertation Award , Human Communication and Technology Division (HCTD), National Communication Association (NCA) |
| 2010 | NORAD Fellowship , Media Studies, University of Oslo, Norway, supported by Norwegian Agency for Development Cooperation (NORAD) |
| 2008 | NOMA Fellowship (2008–2010) , NORAD's Programme for Master Studies in Journalism, Media, and Communication, Norway |

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

Ittefaq, M., Zain, A., Arif, R., **Ala-Uddin, M.**, Ahmad, T., & Iqbal, A. (2024). Global news media coverage of artificial intelligence (AI): A comparative analysis of frames, sentiments, and trends across 12 countries. *Telematics and Informatics*, 96, 102223. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tele.2024.102223>

Ala-Uddin, M. (2019). “Sustainable” discourse: A critical analysis of the 2030 agenda for sustainable development. *Asia Pacific Media Educator*, 29(2), 1–11. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1326365X19881515>

Ala-Uddin, M. (2019). Review essay of *Information and Communication Technology for Development (ICT4D)* [Richard Heeks (Ed.)]. *Asia Pacific Media Educator*, 29(2), 1–4. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1326365X19886979>

Flournoy, D., Roth, S., & **Ala-Uddin, M.** (2014). From uranium enrichment to renewable energy: Conversion of the US-DOE’s former Portsmouth Gaseous Diffusion Plant (PORTS) into a clean energy production facility. *Online Journal of Space Communication*, 10(17), 15.

Book Chapters

Ala-Uddin, M. (2026). Discursive power and digital repression: Global media narratives of the July 2024 uprising. In M. H. Rahman & D. Islam (Eds.), *Critical media perspectives on the July 2024 Bangladesh uprising*. Bloomsbury.

Shahin, S., **Ala-Uddin, M.**, Verma, T., & Matanji, F. B. (forthcoming). Dial M for money: Transnational narratives of mobile money in the global south. In D. K. Thussu & S. Roy (Eds.), *Handbook of communication and media in the global south*. Routledge.

Ala-Uddin, M. (2021). The paradox in discourse and praxis of gender equality: A communicative framework for sustainable development. In M. J. Yusha’u & J. Servaes (Eds.), *The Palgrave handbook of international communication and sustainable development* (pp. 235–257). Palgrave Macmillan. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-69770-9_11

Manuscripts in Progress

Ala-Uddin, M. (Under review). Communication as critical freedom: Toward a Normative Framework for Communicative Justice. Manuscript submitted to *Communication Theory*.

Ala-Uddin, M. (in preparation). Unveiling contextual depths in textual corpora: A computational-critical discourse analysis toward a “thick” reading of data. Manuscript in preparation for submission to *Communication Methods and Measures*.

Ala-Uddin, M. (in preparation). Market logics and digital futures: Comparative news discourses on digitalization in Bangladesh and Norway. Manuscript in preparation for submission to *Information, Communication & Society*.

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PAPERS

- 2026 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Communication as critical freedom: Toward a Normative Framework for Communicative Justice. Top Paper, Philosophy of Communication, Theory, and Critique, National Communication Association (NCA) the 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, Louisiana, November 19–22.
- 2025 **Ala-Uddin, M.** (Panel Chair). From rights movement to regime change: Postmodern resistance through postdigital activism in world's first Gen-Z revolution in Bangladesh [Panel]. National Communication Association (NCA) Annual Convention, Denver, CO.
- 2025 Ali, M., & **Ala-Uddin, M.** Sustaining vs. challenging authoritarianism: The role of news media in Bangladesh. Paper presented at the International Communication Association (ICA) Annual Conference, Denver, CO.
- 2025 Ali, M., Islam, D., & **Ala-Uddin, M.** Creating the bubble around autocracy: News media's role in challenging and sustaining Sheikh Hasina's regime in the global south. Paper presented at the International Communication Association (ICA) Annual Conference, Denver, CO.
- 2024 Ittefaq, M., Zain, A., Khan, M. L., Ahmad, T., Iqbal, A., & **Ala-Uddin, M.** News coverage of artificial intelligence in 12 countries (2013–2023). International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR), Christchurch, New Zealand.
- 2023 **Ala-Uddin, M.**, & Ittefaq, M. Crisis of authenticity in digital freedom: Understanding cybersecurity policy and surveillance practices in South Asia. ICA Annual Conference (Communication Law and Policy Division).
- 2022 **Ala-Uddin, M.** From digitalization to development paradox: A critical reflection on Bangladeshi national ICT policy and practice. 108th NCA Convention, New Orleans, LA.
- 2019 **Ala-Uddin, M.** (Mis)communicating student protest for road safety in Bangladesh: A critical evaluation of state response. NCA Convention, Baltimore, MD.
- 2019 Shahin, S., **Ala-Uddin, M.**, Varma, T., & Matanji, F. Dial M for money: Transnational narratives of mobile money in the global south. 69th ICA Conference, Washington, D.C.
- 2018 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Digitalizing public services and the rising development paradox: A critical reflection on the Bangladeshi national ICT policy and the Digital Security Act. IAMCR Conference, University of Oregon.
- 2018 **Ala-Uddin, M.** The paradox at the declarations of intent and the practical action to improve gender equality and justice: A conceptual framework for SDG 5. IAMCR Conference, University of Oregon.
- 2017 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Advancing social justice for women within Islamic framework: A South Asian case. 6th Annual GCA Conference, Bowling Green State University.

- 2017 **Ala-Uddin, M.** “Tables are turned”: A pursuit of gender justice in Sultana’s Dream. 6th Annual GCA Conference, Bowling Green State University.
- 2017 **Ala-Uddin, M.** “Digital Bangladesh”: Discourse and deconstruction. Central States Communication Association Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN.
- 2016 **Ala-Uddin, M.** “Transforming our world” and the paradox of global partnership in SDGs: A conceptual framework for social justice and empowerment. IAMCR Conference, University of Leicester, U.K.
- 2013 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Defying Bangladeshi gender stereotypes: A social semiology of BBC Janala. Annual Meeting of Semiotic Society of America, Dayton, OH.
- 2013 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Migrants, mobiles, and modernity: A chemistry of capitalism. Global Fusion Conference, Southern Illinois University.
- 2013 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Representation of gender in BBC Janala. 25th Ethnographic and Qualitative Research Conference, Cedarville University, OH.
- 2011 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Freedom of information law in Bangladesh: Is information reachable? International Seminar on Freedom of Expression, University of Dhaka.

GRANTS AND FUNDED PROJECTS

- 2026 Waterhouse Family Institute for the Study of Communication and Society, Villanova University, Villanova, PA. Amount: \$10,000
- 2026 Faculty Summer Research Grants, Saint Mary’s College, IN. Amount: \$2,500
- 2025 First Year Seminar (FYS) Program Grant, *Communicating in the Age of Artificial Intelligence*, Saint Mary’s College. Amount: \$5,000
- 2020 VIVA Course Redesign Mini-Grant, Virtual Library of Virginia. PI: Dr. Timothy Ball, James Madison University. Role: Collaborator. Amount: \$500
- 2018 Improving Agricultural Extension through Communication for Development, USAID. PI: Dr. Robert Agunga, Ohio State University. Partnered with Dr. S. Melkote, Bowling Green State University. Amount: \$8,000

Competitive Professional Development Grants

- 2016 Travel Grant, Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Norway, for IAMCR Conference, Leicester, U.K. Amount: \$1,415
- 2009 Travel Grant, Norwegian Dialogue Project, for HPAIR Academic Conference, Seoul, Korea. Amount: \$1,050

Graduate Assistantships

- 2015–2018 Graduate Teaching Assistantship, School of Media and Communication, Bowling Green State University. Amount: \$47,250 plus tuition scholarship
- 2013–2014 Graduate Research Assistantship, Communication and Development Studies Program, Ohio University. Amount: \$12,330 plus tuition waiver
- 2012–2013 Graduate Recruitment Scholarship, Communication and Development Program, Ohio University. Amount: \$1,800 plus tuition waiver

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2017–2019 **Researcher**, Algorithms, Big Data, and Culture (ABDC) Research Group, Bowling Green State University. Project: *Mobile Money Narratives in Kenya, Bangladesh, and India*. Dr. Saif Shahin (now Tilburg University)
- 2016–2018 **Research Assistant**, School of Media and Communication, Bowling Green State U. Projects: Coding and analysis of restaurant customer reviews on Yelp (Dr. Ilyoung Ju); Documentary website research and redesign (Dr. Thomas Mascaro)
- 2012–2014 **Research Assistant**, School of Media Arts and Studies, Scripps College of Communication, Ohio University. Projects: Creative visualization of solar power satellite (Dr. Don Flournoy); Digital divide study on American county websites (Dr. Lawrence Wood)
- 2011–2012 **Research Associate**, Brooks World Poverty Institute (BWPI), U of Manchester, U.K. Project: *Social pension scheme and poverty reduction in urban Bangladesh*. Administered/transcribed 32 family interviews and five focus groups.
- 2012 **Research Analyst**, Institute for Research and Development, Dhaka, Bangladesh. Project: *Media, Secularization, and Religious Freedom in Bangladesh*

LECTURES, TALKS, AND PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Selected Guest Lectures

- 2025 Global/Digital Media. GLST 101: Introduction to Global Studies (Instructor: Nell Haynes), Department of Global Studies, Saint Mary's College
- 2022 Digital Advocacy and Transnational Activism. SCOM 500: Introduction to Advocacy Studies (Instructor: Peter K. Bsumek), School of Communication Studies, James Madison University
- 2018 ICT for Development and Capabilities Approach. MC 7630: Global Communication and Social Change (Instructor: Dr. Srinivas Melkote), School of Media and Communication, Bowling Green State University
- 2018 Theory and Application of Qualitative Interviewing. MDIA 3600: Media Research (Instructor: Ruonan Zhang), Media Production and Studies Program, Bowling Green State University
- 2017 Global Media and Inequalities in Bangladeshi Contexts. COMM 2100: Communicating in Global Context (Instructor: Emi Kanemoto), School of Media and Communication, Bowling Green State University.
- 2016 History and Political Trajectory of Bangladesh. ASIA 4800 (Instructor: Gi Woong Yun), Asian Studies Program, Bowling Green State University.

Public Scholarship

- 2025 Ala-Uddin, M. Development or deception? The myth of progress under the fallen Hasina regime. *The Insighta*, March 1, 2025.
<https://theinsighta.com/p/development-or-deprivation-the-illusion>

- 2024 Panel Speaker. Reforming Communication in New Bangladesh: Towards Sustainable and Independent Media. Bangladeshi Communication Scholars in North America, September 29
- 2023 Invited Speaker. Faith in the Valley: Muslim Festivals Across Cultures. The Lifelong Learning Institute (LLI), James Madison University
- 2021 Invited Speaker. Lessons of Social Justice from Prophet Mohammad. The Interfaith Association (IFA) and Valley Muslim Community Foundation (VMCF), Harrisonburg, VA
- 2010 Invited Speaker. State of Press Freedom in Bangladesh. Nordic Summer Camp, Jyväskylä, Finland

Media Appearances

- 2024–present **Ala-Uddin, M.** Recurring panel guest on “Our Democracy” [Television]. *TBN24*. Discussions on democracy, governance, and media in the U.S. and South Asia.
- 2024 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Panel guest on “Road to White House” [Television]. *TBN24*. November 2 and November 4.
- 2011 **Ala-Uddin, M.** Panelist on “Religious Thoughts” [Television]. *Diganta Television*. Discussed religiosity, free expression, and modernity.

SERVICE TO PROFESSION

Journal Manuscript Reviewer (20 Reviews Total)

New Media and Society (3); *AI and Ethics* (2); *Information Technology and Politics* (1); *Oxford Intersections: Social Media in Society and Culture* (3); *Journalism* (1); *Asia Pacific Media Educator* (5); *British Journal of Sociology* (1); *Asian Journal of Social Science* (1); *Culture and Society in South Asia* (1); *Journal of Creative Communication* (2); and *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* (1)

Book Manuscript Reviewer

Mizan-Rahman, M. (2026). *Plasticocene Futures: Garbage, Empire, and the Search for Ecological Justice*. Illinois University Press

Conference Paper Reviewer

International Communication Association (ICA)

Reviewed for 2019-2026 (Divisions reviewed for: Global Communication and Social Change; Computational Methods; Communication and Technology; Communication Law and Policy; Race and Ethnicity in Communication)

National Communication Association (NCA)

Reviewed for 2019-2025 (Divisions reviewed for: Activism and Social Justice; Critical and Cultural Studies; Human Communication and Technology)

International Conference on the July Revolution (ICJR-I 2025)

The Legacy of the July Revolution 2024: Rebuilding Bangladesh (Theme)

Review Subcommittee Chair /Adjudicator for thematic track: *Media Censorship, Freedom of Speech, and Digital Repression*

56 extended abstracts reviewed and adjudicated the final selection of 5 paper presentations and 5 poster presentations

Professional Roles

Member, Thesis and Dissertation Award Committee, Human Communication and Technology Division, National Communication Association (NCA)

Co-Founder and Deputy Director, Center for South Asian Media and Culture (CSAMC)

Managing Editor, *The Insighta*, a public scholarship media outlet

Conference Roles

Respondent, “Radical Intimacies: Feminine Futures in Film, Flesh, and Fire” [Panel], NCA 2025, Denver, CO

Panel Chair, “From Rights Movement to Regime Change,” NCA 2025, Denver, CO

Session Chair, Sustainable Development: Paradoxes, Promises and Challenges for Women in News Media, International Association for Media and Communication Research/ IAMCR 2018, Eugene, OR

SERVICE TO UNIVERSITY

Saint Mary’s College

Advisory Faculty, Institutional AI Taskforce

Member, Global Studies Steering Committee (GLST)

Member, Faculty Affairs and Development Committee (FAD)

James Madison University

Member, President’s Special Task Force on Generative AI, 2023–2024

Member, Research Committee, School of Communication Studies, 2023–2024

Faculty Adviser, Muslim Students Association (MSA)

Reviewer, GEC Collaborative Development Grants 2023, General Education Council

Member, Outreach, Engagement, and Diversity Committee, 2021–2022

Member, JMU Faculty Senate, 2019–2024

Member, Search Committee for Lecturer of Communication Studies, 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Saint Mary's College (Assistant Professor, 2024–present)

AI and the Future of Communication; Public Communication; Critical Issues in Mass Communication; Argumentation and Advocacy; Intercultural Communication; Introduction to Communication Studies

James Madison University (Lecturer, 2019–2024)

Culture and Health Communication; New Media and Health; Intercultural Communication; Introduction to Communication Research; Fundamentals of Human Communication

Bowling Green State University (Teaching Associate, 2015–2019)

Introduction to Journalism in Democratic Society; Introduction to Public Speaking

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Communications and Outreach Coordinator, Bangladesh Youth Environmental Initiative, Dhaka (2011–2012). Project: Earth Champion Program, supported by U.S. State Department.

Sub-Editor, International Desk, *The Daily Jaijaidin*, Dhaka, Bangladesh (2007–2010)

Communication in charge (Jan–Jun 2008), Centre for Debate & Public Communication (CDPC), Dhaka, Bangladesh. *Project: Capacity Building Initiative for Educational Institutions*, supported by IDEA, UK & Netherlands.

Feature Writer, *The Daily Jaijaidin*, Dhaka, Bangladesh (2006–2008). International and humanitarian affairs.

TRAINING AND CERTIFICATION

FYS Dialogue Across Differences, Saint Mary's College, trained by [Essential Partners](#), 2025

ACUE Course on Fostering a Culture of Belonging, Association of College and University Educators, 2024

Computational Text Analysis in Python, taught by Dr. Naeemul Hassan, University of Maryland (10 weeks), 2023

Java Programming, Dept. of Computer Science, James Madison University, 2021

Racial Equity Workshop: Understanding Racism in its Structural Form, Racial Equity Institute, Harrisonburg, VA, 2019

New Media and Democratization, International Summer School, University of Oslo, Norway (6 weeks), 2010

ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS

International Communication Association (ICA)

International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR)

National Communication Association (NCA)

DIGITAL SKILLS

Text Mining and Analytics: LLM, TopicGPT, NLTK, spaCy, Netlytic, Python, R

Data Analysis: NVivo, SPSS

Digital Production: Java, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Dreamweaver, Photoshop, InDesign

LANGUAGES

Bengali (native); English (fluent); Arabic (working knowledge); Urdu (basic)

Mohammad Ala-Uddin

August 15, 2026